



Insight into Accessories

Accessories are hotter than ever before, and we speak to industry experts to understand why

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One of the ways by which we can add more functionality to our gadgets is by installing apps. There are literally millions of apps in the marketplace waiting to transform your device, making it act in ways you never thought possible. But what about the physical limitations of your smartphone, tablet or laptop? Drop an iPad and you know in your heart that it's not going to end well. Or at the end of a particularly hectic day you find your smartphone running out of juice. Or perhaps your laptop is overheating way

market for accessories in India is still small. Here it's estimated at around \$3 million but it's growing steadily thanks to the increase in the spending power of the people. This immense growth has been partly due to the fact that the smartphone is now part of daily life, especially in the past two years," said Dinesh.

Head of Category Management, at eBay India seems to agree with this growth story. "With increasing popularity of Tablets we have seen a year-on-year growth of 250 per cent in accessories for this category. We've also witnessed an impressive growth of over 100 per cent for mobile phones car kits and chargers, followed by cases and pouches for tech

products like laptops, tablets and mobile phones etc.," he said.

Spending in the accessories space can be measured and Zebronics Director, Rajesh Doshi has an interesting take on how to do this. According to him, "The accessories market in India is not as big as developed markets. The accessories market in India for laptop is around 10 per cent of the laptop price over the lifetime of the device. This would mean for

a laptop worth ₹30,000, on average consumers here will spend around ₹3,000 on the accessories, whereas in developed markets, it's around 30 per cent."

Why this boom in accessories?

We spoke to Crane Chen, India Country Manager for Cooler Master and came away with a few insights. He lists down a few reasons for this growth:

Market maturity: The Indian consumer is slowly making tracks for mobile devices (laptops, smartphones, etc.). Availability of affordable smartphones, relatively cheap netbooks and, lately, tablet computing is driving this acceptance. As they gravitate towards these devices, they

find the experience incomplete without supporting accessories. For e.g. in case of smartphones, the battery life is always a concern and hence battery backup packs become a necessity. Netbook/ultrabooks are slim, so there's a need for protection cases, folios, NB coolers etc. Tablets are



iPad sleeves are popular

redefining the way we consume media and have spawned their own range of accessories e.g. folios, stylus pens, protection cases, stands, etc. customised for this category. In today's scenario, these auxiliary devices a.k.a. accessories are a need rather than a want.

Availability: A few years back if you wanted to buy accessories you would've probably ended up with cheap Chinese knockoffs. But today, all global brands are available at your neighbouring store; that too at reasonable prices. Large retailers (Croma, eZone), specialty retailers (Apple stores) and booming online shops ensure that



A category fast catching up

product availability isn't an issue anymore – you don't have to hunt the market in the hot sun for hours for a



"With newer user groups coming in, there's a big opportunity for accessories to represent the consumer's lifestyle"

Rajesh Doshi,
Director, Zebronics

beyond the accepted norms. No app will come to your rescue in such cases. The only thing that can help you is a good ol' real world accessory: a battery pack for your phone, hardcase for your iPad and a cooler for your laptop. And it's not just limitations that can be overcome by accessories. People all over the world add their own personal touch to their gadgets by using accessories to bling 'em up.

One thing is for certain, the action is not just in the apps space. The accessories business is heating up like crazy. According to Pinakin Dinesh, CEO of Amzer, an accessories maker, the accessories market is worth around \$40 billion, and is estimated to reach \$150 billion by 2020.

"Accessories generated \$28 billion in revenue last year alone, however the